

Guaranteeing Failure

I can't say this enough: Believing the myths about wealth and the wealthy will prevent you from ever becoming wealthy yourself. Saying *I can't* or *It's not possible for someone like me* will become a self-fulfilling prophecy. You'll be shortchanging your potential and guaranteeing your own failure.

By now, the phrase "someone like me" should have new meaning to you. We've seen over and over again that the typical millionaire in this country is someone just like you. These men and women are regular people. They didn't have special advantages, and they weren't born rich. They came from little (or nothing) and still came out on top. Rob, who we got to know in chapter 1, grew up on a farm and only had one good pair of pants for school each year. Sandra, in chapter 2, grew up in a frugal family who had just enough to meet their needs and nothing more. Neither of these folks were content with the hand they were dealt, so they changed the game. Instead of letting their backgrounds hold them back, these two used their experiences as a springboard to shoot them further than their parents ever hoped to go.

The millionaires we studied didn't have an inside track on some mysterious investment scheme; they simply used commonly available retirement plans. Remember, they viewed the standard, *boring* company retirement plan as the number one contributor to their high net worth. In chapter 2, we saw that Mack, a retired military man and insurance professional, was able to become a millionaire and retire at age fifty-six—just by consistently investing into his company retirement plan. Clark, in chapter 3, intentionally stayed away from high-risk investments and focused almost exclusively on the 401(k) through his company. He retired wealthy too.

The average millionaire also doesn't have a crazy-high salary; he or she just has a regular job. In chapter 3, we saw that Larry retired with millions in his 401(k) at age fifty-five, and he did it by making saving a priority